

1. (20 points) In response to a serious intrusion, the university system president directed that an intrusion detection system be installed on each campus to monitor the network traffic of the campus network. The goal was to allow the system information security officers (SSOs) to detect and co-ordinate responses to attacks that spanned multiple campuses. The intrusion detection system was placed outside the campus gateway, so it could only record traffic crossing the gateway. It did not try to block any traffic, nor was it able to decrypt any encrypted traffic. The campus information security officers (CSOs) were told of the installation, and were also told not to reveal it for legal reasons. No-one else on campus was told of the additional monitoring. What was the effect of the failure to inform the campus community of the existence of this monitoring system? How do you think it impacted the security of the campus?

Answer: The effect would be that there would be a breach in privacy. As students have not been informed of this new change, any consent forms they may have signed as part of their registration for the school would not be valid in a court case. The deliberate act of concealing monitoring network traffic may lead to legal issues, specifically that any evidence gathered during the monitoring may be denied in court. Additionally, there may be loss of trust between network users and the university as the secrecy may undermine previous trust relationships. I think that this may have helped a little at first while attackers were unaware of monitoring, but they just traded this one smaller success for results that may have been more conducive to the task of protecting the university network. So I think this did not greatly improve the security of the campus. Users could have more impactfully improved the security by being aware and using good security practices.